Derek Serrano

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Software Engineer building scalable backend and full-stack applications using Java (Spring Boot) and TypeScript. Experienced in developing RESTful APIs, working with distributed systems, and delivering reliable, business-critical solutions while solving complex production issues.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer – Intact Insurance June 2024 – present

- Built and deployed backend services using TypeScript (Angular) and Java (Spring Boot) across a distributed microservices architecture (~20 services), supporting 50K+ users
- Owned end-to end development for 3–5 services, breaking down business requirements into scalable technical solutions and delivering features iteratively for $1M+ commercial insurance products
- Implemented Kafka-based messaging to enable asynchronous processing and improve system scalability; deployed services on Kubernetes using CI/CD pipelines, reducing API latency by 30%
- Wrote unit and integration tests to ensure code quality, maintainability, and reliable feature delivery
- Led production incident response using Dynatrace and ElasticSearch, monitoring system metrics, and resolving complex production issues to improve system reliability, reducing MTTR by 35%
- Led migration of 10+ microservices from Spring Boot 5 to Spring Boot 6, resolving dependency conflicts and improving system maintainability across distributed services
- Designed and optimized both SQL and NoSQL data models (PostgreSQL, MongoDB), improving query performance and supporting large-scale data processing and backend data operations

Software Engineer Intern – Intact Insurance May 2022 – Aug 2023

- Contributed to backend feature development and bug fixes within a Java-based microservices system
- Gained hands-on experience with CI/CD pipelines, code reviews, and production release processes

Machine Learning Research Assistant – Healthcare Systems R&A May 2021 – August 2021

- Collaborated with researchers and engineers to develop computer vision–based image processing tools for lab testing workflows
- Implemented and evaluated machine learning models including SVMs and neural networks, contributing to experimental pipelines and model validation, and performance evaluation

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, JavaScript, Typescript, Python, C/C++, SQL
Frameworks & Architecture: React, Angular, Node.js, REST APIs, Distributed Systems
Infrastructure: MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Azure, AWS, Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, Kafka
CI/CD & Tooling: Jenkins, Git, Nexus, Dynatrace, Elasticsearch

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Computer Engineering / McMaster University • 2019-2024 • GPA: 3.9